

DADP GAME GROUP REFLECTION

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Group Game Development Reflection

Our expedition through the development of the "THATHA TRIBE" has been an intricate dance between triumphs and tribulations. Our collective effort aimed to weave an engaging narrative set in the hunter-gatherer era, yet the path we treaded was laden with challenges that revealed both our strengths and weaknesses.

Evolution of the Game:

Opting for a transition from a 3D to a 2D top-down perspective was a tactical decision, spurred by the need to navigate complexities in our code, mitigate commit delays, and enhance our agility in incorporating animations and enemies. Initially met with skepticism, this alteration proved to be a pragmatic choice that streamlined our development process.

Roles and Responsibilities:

Our team structure, with Makhado as the Project Manager and Artist, Thoriso and Mpendulo as Programmers, Desh as the Level Designer, and Ndiwanga handling UI and level design transitions, aimed for a harmonious collaboration. However, the execution revealed stark variations in commitment and contribution.

- Thoriso (Programmer - UI and Weapons): Thoriso grappled with time constraints and procrastination, delaying the initiation of the UI weapons. While the inventory system eventually functioned, its completion occurred when its relevance had waned.

- Ndiwanga (UI and Level Design): Ndiwanga emerged as a diligent contributor, excelling in crafting the UI and ensuring seamless transitions between levels. His commitment to his responsibilities shone through, impacting the overall design positively.

- Mpendulo (Programmer - Interactables): Mpendulo's initial lack of inspiration and engagement hindered progress. Despite a late surge in activity, he succeeded in programming interactables, overcoming script errors to facilitate player interaction.

- Desh (Level Designer and Narrative): Unfortunately, Desh's performance fell below expectations. Assigned the critical roles of Level Designer and Narrative contributor, his output was minimal. Lack of NPC interaction and delayed contributions marred the intended impact.

- Makhado (Project Manager and Artist, Animator, AI, Weapons, UI): As the Project Manager and Artist, Makhado exhibited commendable leadership and artistic prowess, steering the project with a clear vision and ensuring cohesion amid challenges - In addition to his pivotal roles in enemy and player AI, animations, and weapon development, the creation of power-ups added a layer of dynamism to the game. Makhado's commitment to these responsibilities, coupled with his willingness to offer assistance to team members, underscores a robust work ethic.

Challenges Faced:

The root cause of delays in our project was a confluence of intricate code, wavering commitment among team members, deliberations around alternative approaches, and the persistent spectre of time constraints. These challenges, though formidable, underscored the necessity for adaptability and resilience.

Individual Reflections:

Within this symphony of varied contributions and challenges, individual reflections become crucial. Honest self-assessment is the bedrock for personal growth and collective improvement. Each member faced unique obstacles, and acknowledgment of both successes and shortcomings will pave the way forward.

In Conclusion:

Our game development odyssey was a gritty narrative of perseverance and learning. While our sails were buffeted by the storms of delays and unmet expectations, the project weathered through, driven by the collective spirit of those who honored their responsibilities. As we navigate future ventures, these lessons will undoubtedly shape a more resilient and cohesive team.